November 4th, 2026

MPAD2003A Introductory Data Storytelling

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Presented to Jean-Sébastien Marier

Deliverable 2: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)

Links to the Google Sheets

Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_of_2022
Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_of_2023
Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_of_2024
Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_of_2025

BookTok_Readings_Lists

1. Getting Data

I began by locating the 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025 datasets for the most requested titles at the Ottawa Public Library on Open Ottawa, and downloaded each dataset in CSV format. I then entered an empty Google Sheets document, where I clicked file -> import, and uploaded the CSV files one at a time and then imported the data.

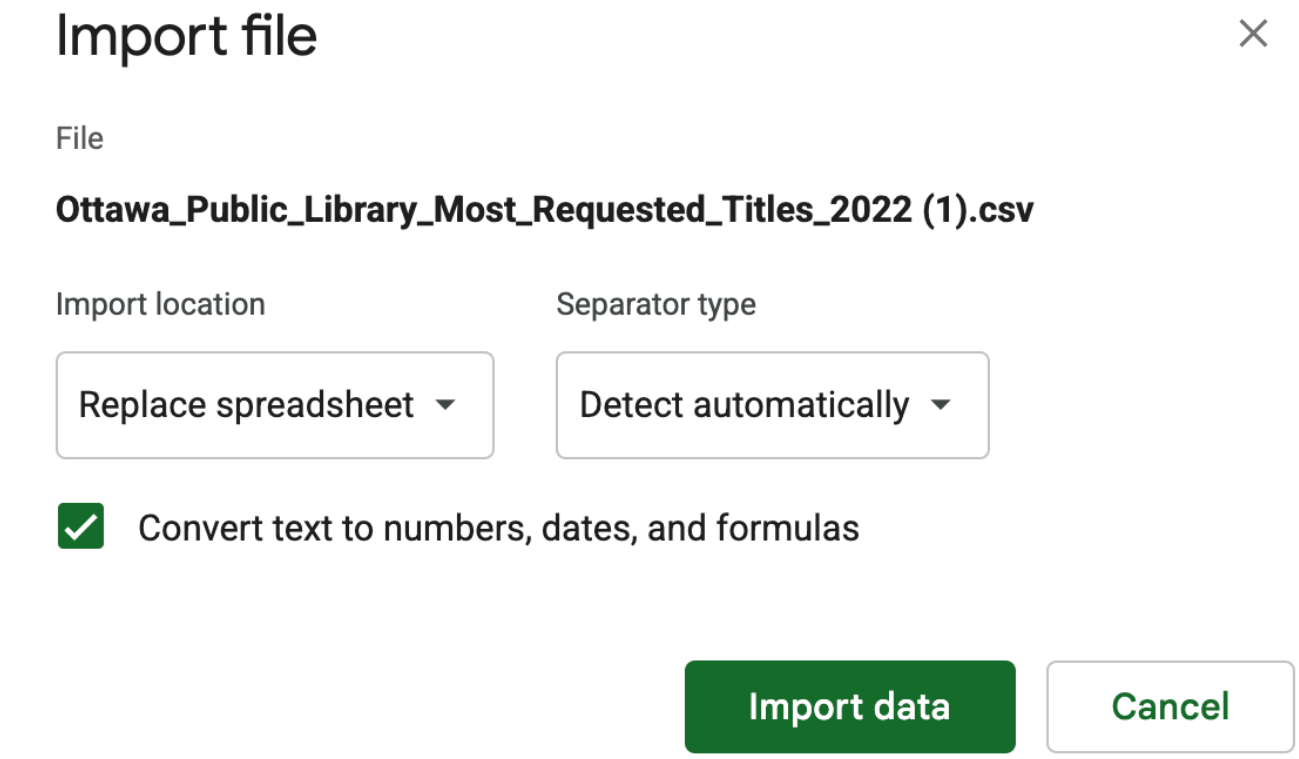


Figure 1: The "Import File" prompt on Google Sheets for the 2022 dataset.

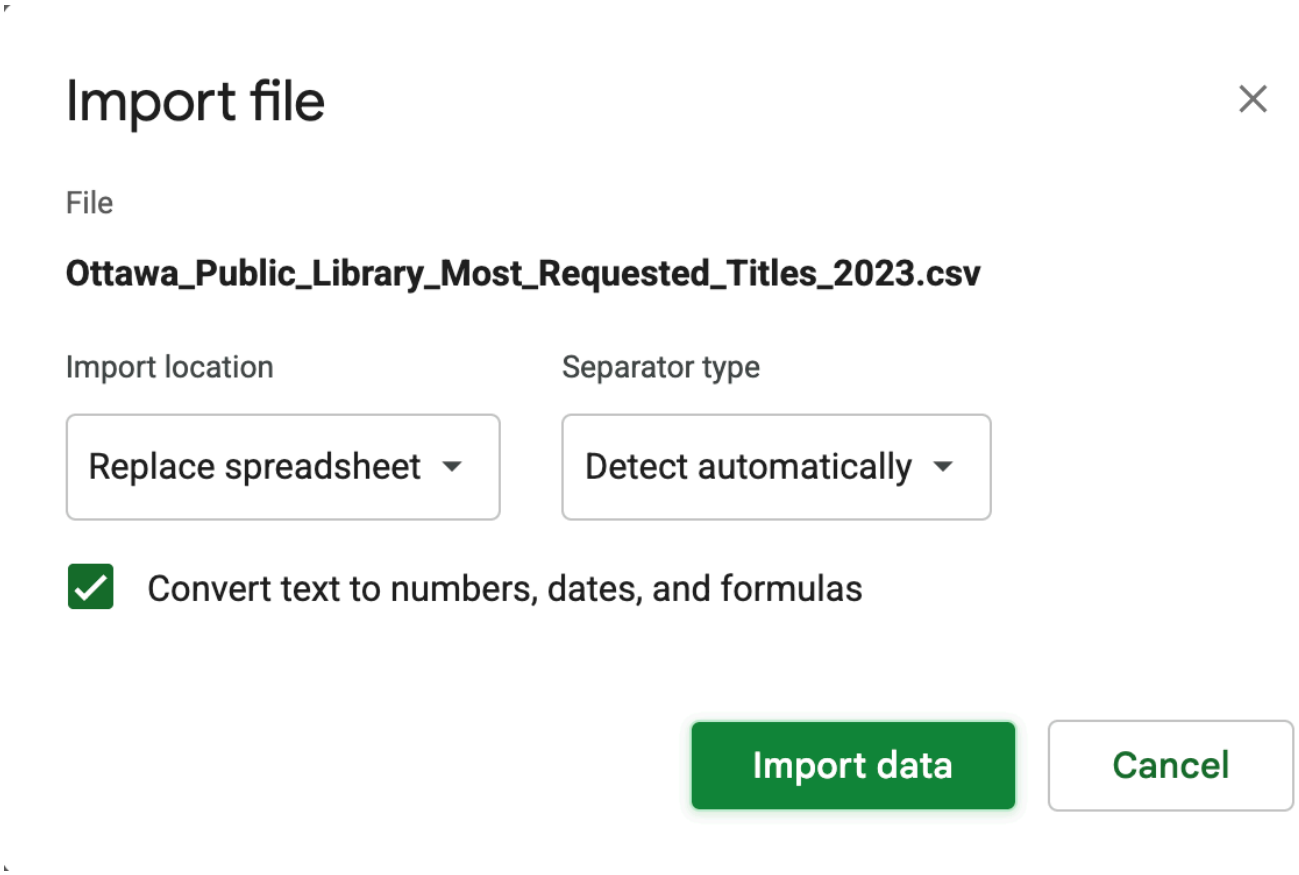


Figure 2: The "Import File" prompt on Google Sheets for the 2023 dataset.

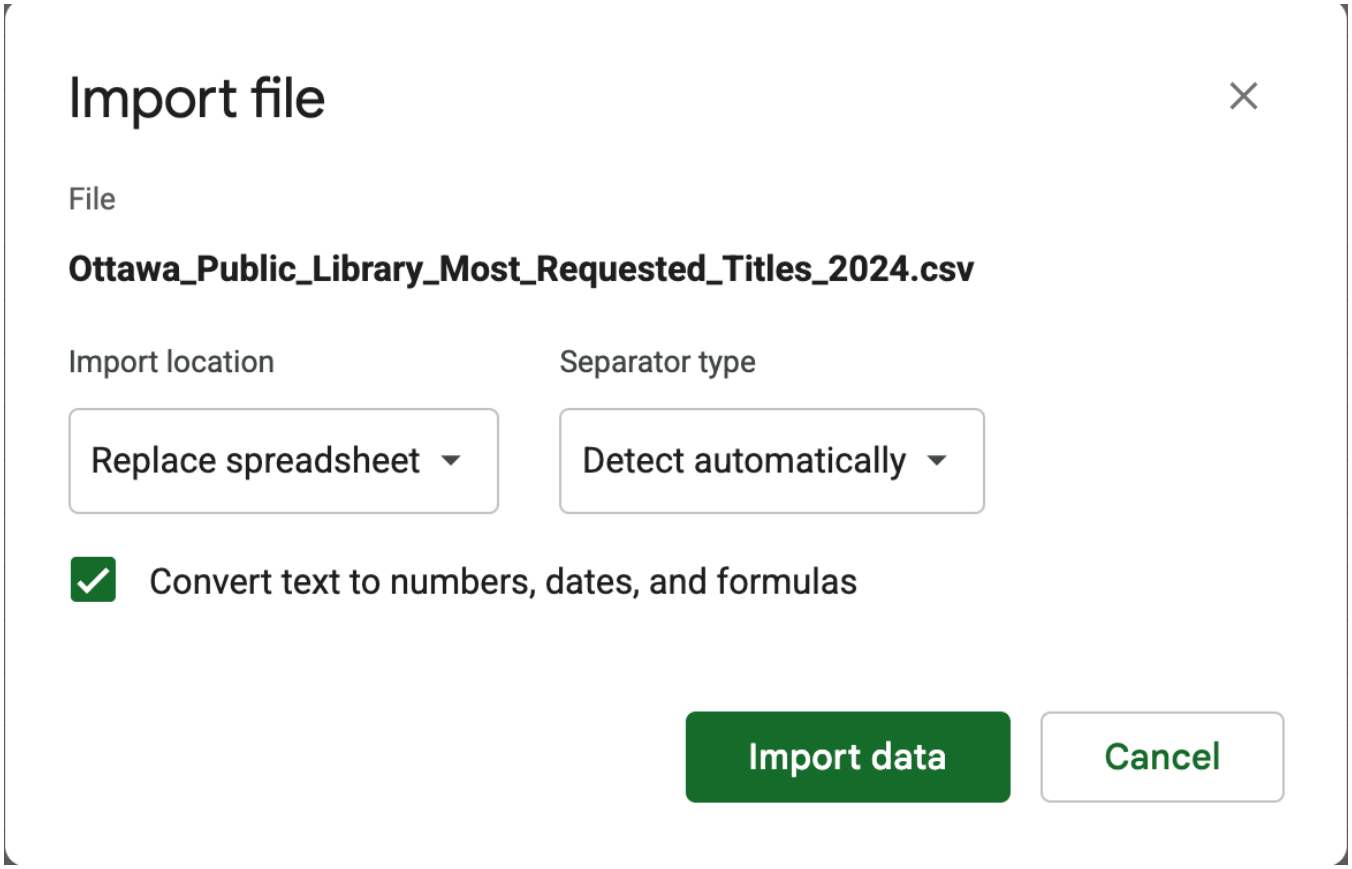


Figure 3: The "Import File" prompt on Google Sheets for the 2024 dataset.

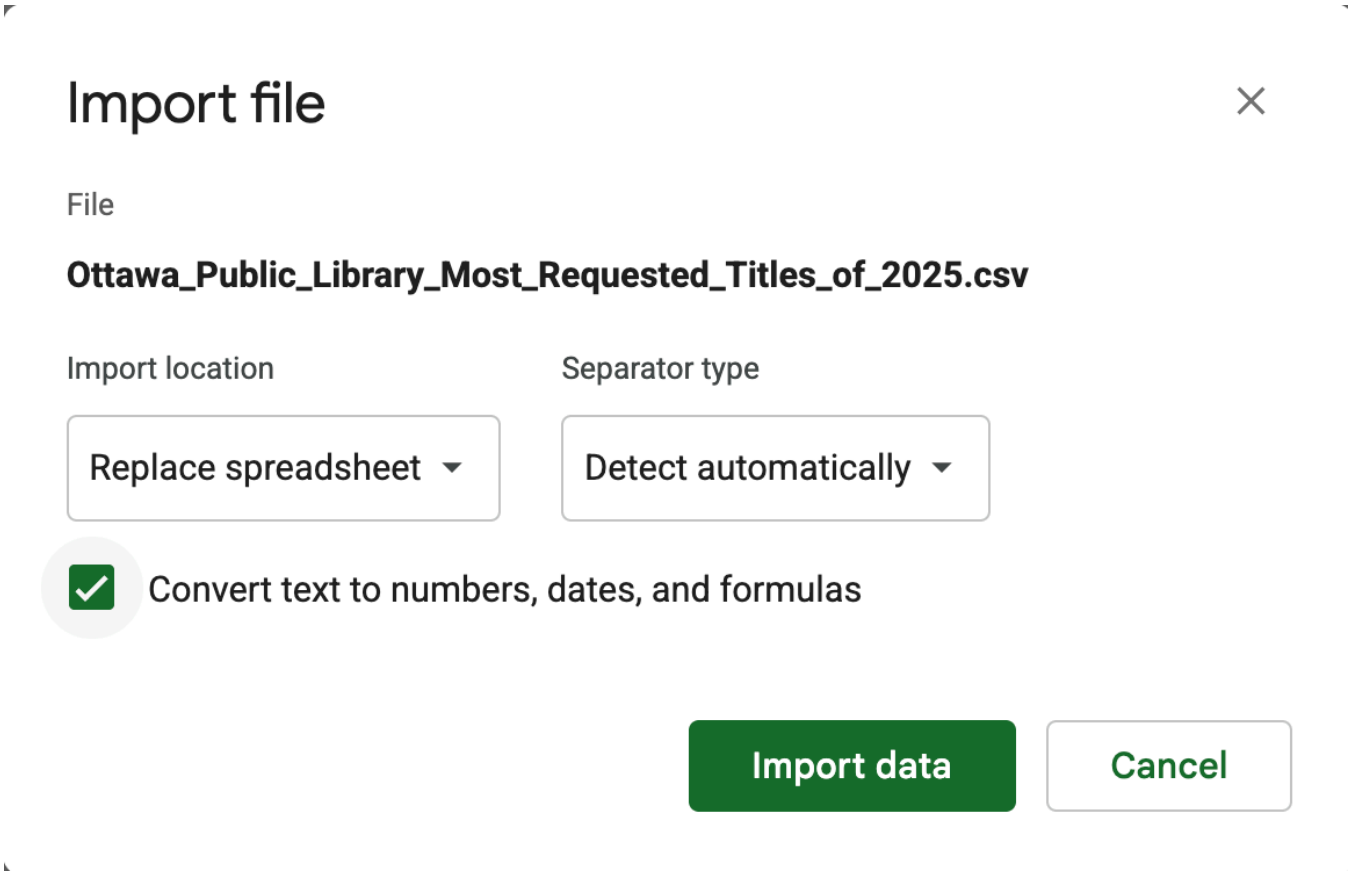


Figure 4: The "Import File" prompt on Google Sheets for the 2025 dataset.

The 2022 list of most requested titles has 57,050 rows (excluding the title row), and 13 columns. The data is relatively clean, but does have a few missing values in the author column (G).

The 2023 list of most requested titles has 96,113 rows (excluding the title row), and 13 columns. This set is also very clean, but also has several missing values in column G.

The 2024 list of most requested titles has 135,036 rows (excluding the title row), and 14 columns. There appear to be far less missing values in column G, but there are certainly still empty slots.

The 2025 list of most requested titles has 126,969 rows (excluding the title row), and 14 columns. Again, column G is missing a few values.

The most relevant columns in all of these datasets will be column D, which contains the book titles, and H, which contains the number of holds.

I intend to compare these datasets to social media "reading lists" for the corresponding years, so for research p I also located articles that listed the 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025 most recommended titles on BookTok. I then opened up another empty Google Sheet file and used the following commands:

1. For the 2022 list:
   `=IMPORTHTML("https://mashable.com/article/most-read-books-2022-tiktok", "list")`
2. For the 2023 list:
   `=IMPORTXML("https://www.usmagazine.com/entertainment/news/2023-booktok-recommendations-`
3. For the 2024 list:
   `=IMPORTXML("https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/culture-lists/booktok-best-books-2024-`
4. For the 2025 list:
   `=IMPORTXML("https://www.kobo.com/blog/the-best-book-booktok-2025", "//h2")`

2. Understanding Data

2.1. VIMO Analysis

According to the metadata, this information is provided by the Ottawa Public Library, and the contact is listed as OPL Finance and Business Services.

As seen in Rohrer (2023), when you are attempting to estimate the prevalence of something, like BookTok influence in Ottawa, it's important to have a representative sample of the population of interest. In this case, we are interested in Ottawa readers, but unfortunately, these datasets exclude digital platforms like OverDrive.

This means that an entire demographic of readers, those borrowing on the Libby app, are not being represented in this data. Though it is unfortunate because I think that data would tell an interesting story about the increase of people borrowing audiobooks and reading digitially since COVID, I don't think it will significantly impact my intended story about how TikTok has influenced Ottawa readers, as that is still evident in the hold statistics.

Furthermore, I identified some interesting stories in my pitch that described Ottawa bookstores having an increased demand for certain titles and genres. This exploration would not require any data from Libby, as bookstores are only handling physical copies.

Additionally, "estimating causal effects from observational data requires a lot of assumptions"

(Rohrer, 2023) and that the "correlation you observe in your sample won't necessarily be the correlation in the population" (Rohrer, 2023). This is important to consider as Ottawa readers could be being influenced by friends, family, neighbors, or coworkers as opposed to being persuaded directly by influencers on BookTok.

As mentioned previously, there are several missing values in the author column of each dataset. For example, the second title in the 2025 dataset, *Yellowstone*, does not name an author. Fortunately, no other columns in the first 100 rows are missing any information.

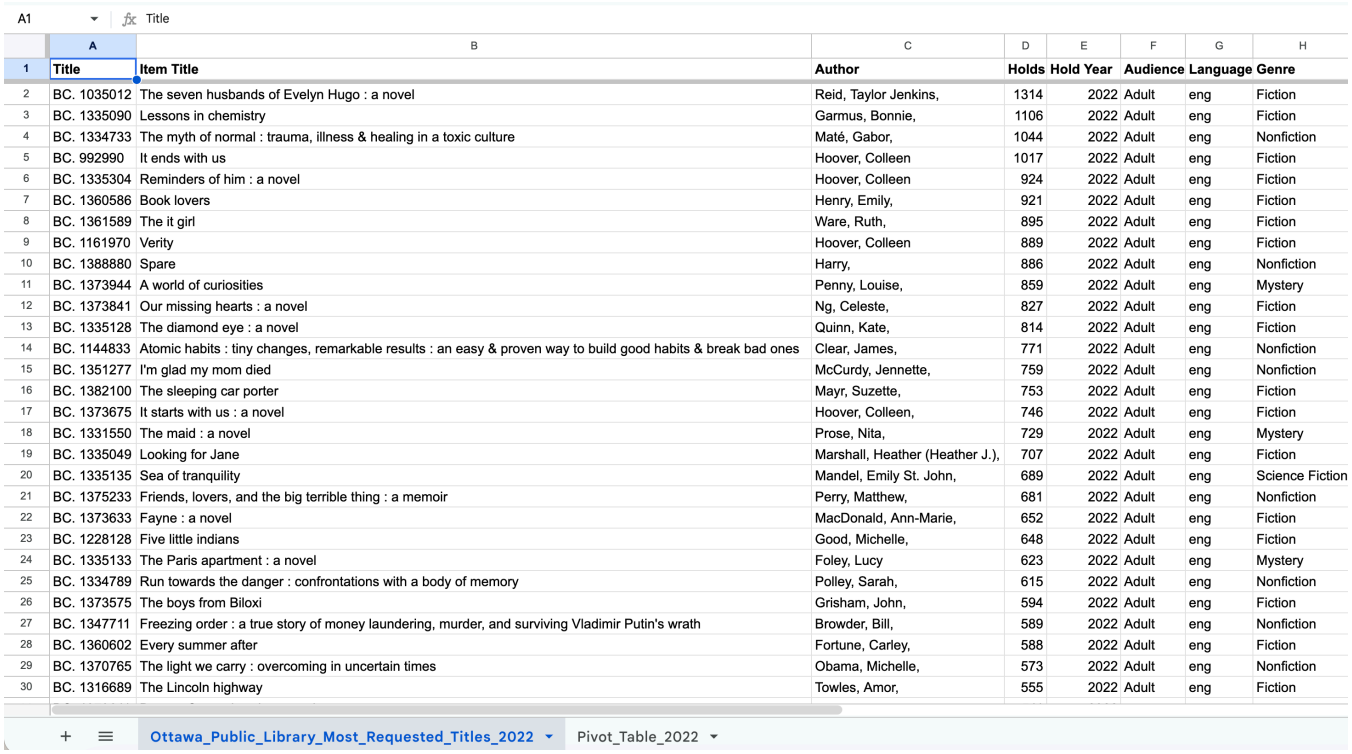
2.2. Cleaning Data

I began by selecting the first 100 titles of each set, which I pasted into a new sheet (no longer attached to the import). I deleted all of the unnesecary columns for my intended story, which were Collection, Catalogue, Format, FID, and Object ID. I froze the first row and bolded the titles of each column for clarity.

The 2025 dataset was not organized from most requested to least requested like the others, so I had to sort the sheet by column F (amount of holds) Z-A so that it would display the title with the most holds of 2025 as the first item, and the rest in decreasing order.

I filled in the missing author value in the 2025 list by searching up the Title and Item Title in my browser and finding the attributed author.

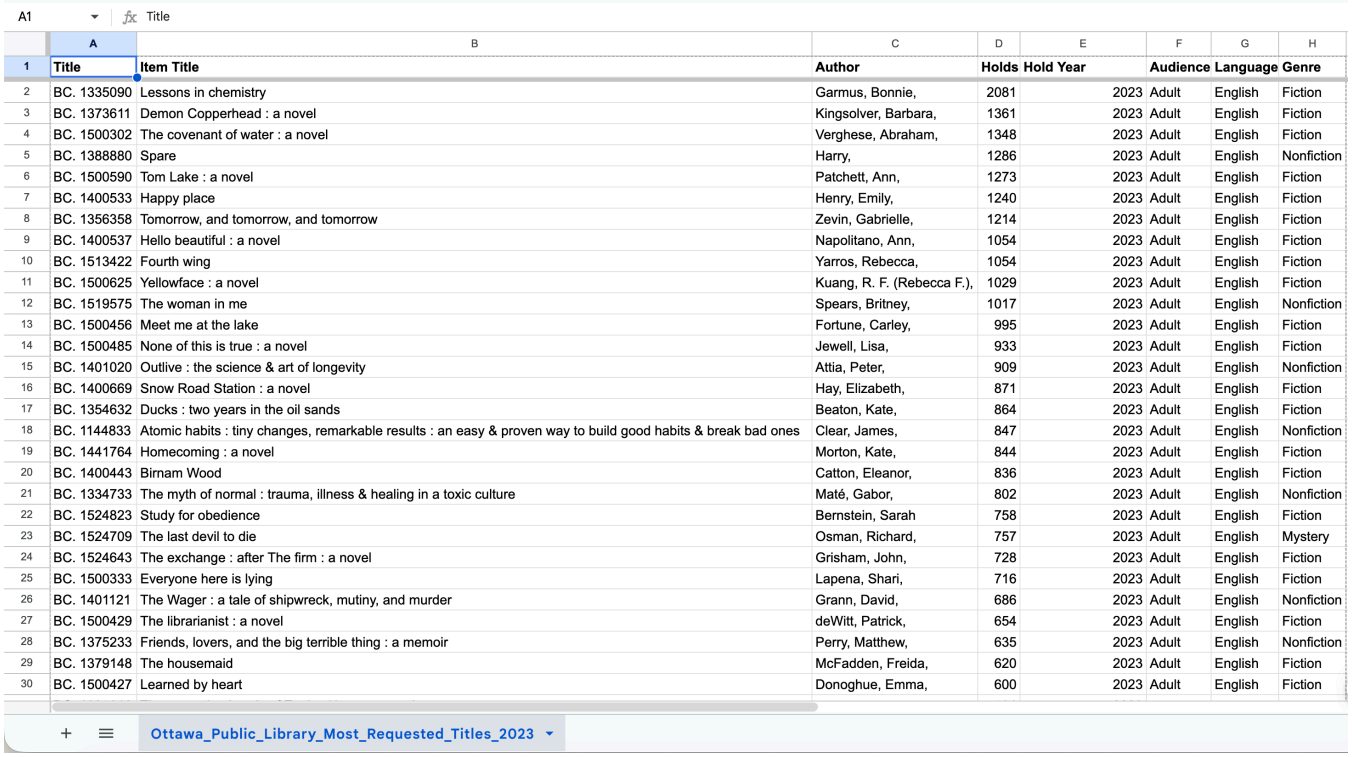
Finally, I used find and replace to remove the slashes that appear after every item title, and made sure to identify the holds column as numbers with no visible decimal place.



	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Title	Item Title	Author	Holds	Hold Year	Audience	Language	Genre
2	BC. 1035012	The seven husbands of Evelyn Hugo : a novel	Reid, Taylor Jenkins,	1314	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
3	BC. 1335090	Lessons in chemistry	Garmus, Bonnie,	1106	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
4	BC. 1334733	The myth of normal : trauma, illness & healing in a toxic culture	Maté, Gabor,	1044	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
5	BC. 992990	It ends with us	Hoover, Colleen	1017	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
6	BC. 1335304	Reminders of him : a novel	Hoover, Colleen	924	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
7	BC. 1360586	Book lovers	Henry, Emily,	921	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
8	BC. 1361589	The it girl	Ware, Ruth,	895	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
9	BC. 1161970	Verity	Hoover, Colleen	889	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
10	BC. 1388880	Spare	Harry,	886	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
11	BC. 1373944	A world of curiosities	Penny, Louise,	859	2022	Adult	eng	Mystery
12	BC. 1373841	Our missing hearts : a novel	Ng, Celeste,	827	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
13	BC. 1335128	The diamond eye : a novel	Quinn, Kate,	814	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
14	BC. 1144833	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	Clear, James,	771	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
15	BC. 1351277	I'm glad my mom died	McCurdy, Jennette,	759	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
16	BC. 1382100	The sleeping car porter	Mayr, Suzette,	753	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
17	BC. 1373675	It starts with us : a novel	Hoover, Colleen,	746	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
18	BC. 1331550	The maid : a novel	Prose, Nita,	729	2022	Adult	eng	Mystery
19	BC. 1335049	Looking for Jane	Marshall, Heather (Heather J.),	707	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
20	BC. 1335135	Sea of tranquility	Mandel, Emily St. John,	689	2022	Adult	eng	Science Fiction
21	BC. 1375233	Friends, lovers, and the big terrible thing : a memoir	Perry, Matthew,	681	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
22	BC. 1373633	Fayne : a novel	MacDonald, Ann-Marie,	652	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
23	BC. 1228128	Five little indians	Good, Michelle,	648	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
24	BC. 1335133	The Paris apartment : a novel	Foley, Lucy	623	2022	Adult	eng	Mystery
25	BC. 1334789	Run towards the danger : confrontations with a body of memory	Polley, Sarah,	615	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
26	BC. 1373575	The boys from Biloxi	Grisham, John,	594	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
27	BC. 1347711	Freezing order : a true story of money laundering, murder, and surviving Vladimir Putin's wrath	Browder, Bill,	589	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
28	BC. 1360602	Every summer after	Fortune, Carley,	588	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction
29	BC. 1370765	The light we carry : overcoming in uncertain times	Obama, Michelle,	573	2022	Adult	eng	Nonfiction
30	BC. 1316689	The Lincoln highway	Towles, Amor,	555	2022	Adult	eng	Fiction

Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_2022 | Pivot_Table_2022

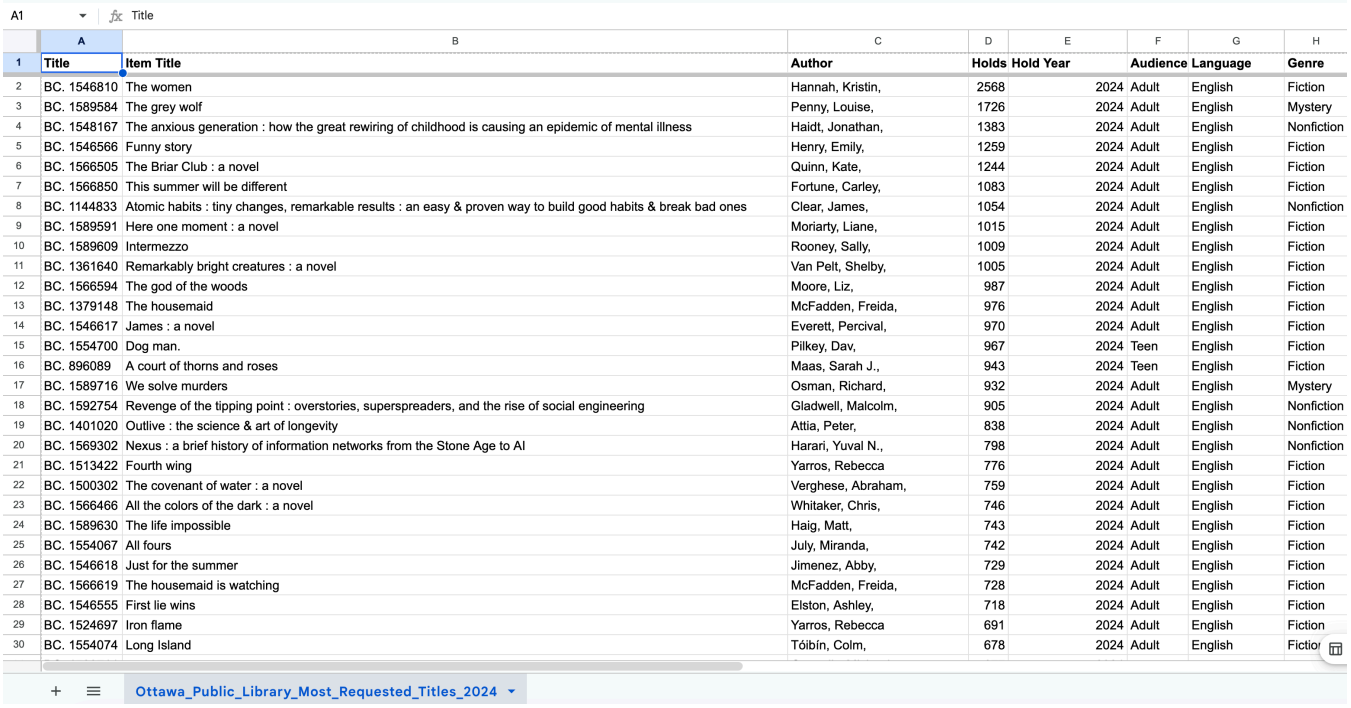
Figure 5: This screen capture shows the first 30 items in the cleaned 2022 Most Requested Titles dataset in Google Sheets.



	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Title	Item Title	Author	Holds	Hold Year	Audience	Language	Genre
2	BC. 1335090	Lessons in chemistry	Garmus, Bonnie,	2081	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
3	BC. 1373611	Demon Copperhead : a novel	Kingsolver, Barbara,	1361	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
4	BC. 1500302	The covenant of water : a novel	Verghese, Abraham,	1348	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
5	BC. 1388880	Spare	Harry,	1286	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
6	BC. 1500590	Tom Lake : a novel	Patchett, Ann,	1273	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
7	BC. 1400533	Happy place	Henry, Emily,	1240	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
8	BC. 1356358	Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow	Zevin, Gabrielle,	1214	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
9	BC. 1400537	Hello beautiful : a novel	Napolitano, Ann,	1054	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
10	BC. 1513422	Fourth wing	Yarros, Rebecca,	1054	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
11	BC. 1500625	Yellowface : a novel	Kuang, R. F. (Rebecca F.),	1029	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
12	BC. 1519575	The woman in me	Spears, Britney,	1017	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
13	BC. 1500456	Meet me at the lake	Fortune, Carley,	995	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
14	BC. 1500485	None of this is true : a novel	Jewell, Lisa,	933	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
15	BC. 1401020	Outlive : the science & art of longevity	Attia, Peter,	909	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
16	BC. 1400669	Snow Road Station : a novel	Hay, Elizabeth,	871	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
17	BC. 1354632	Ducks : two years in the oil sands	Beaton, Kate,	864	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
18	BC. 1144833	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	Clear, James,	847	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
19	BC. 1441764	Homecoming : a novel	Morton, Kate,	844	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
20	BC. 1400443	Birnam Wood	Catton, Eleanor,	836	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
21	BC. 1334733	The myth of normal : trauma, illness & healing in a toxic culture	Maté, Gabor,	802	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
22	BC. 1524823	Study for obedience	Bernstein, Sarah	758	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
23	BC. 1524709	The last devil to die	Osman, Richard,	757	2023	Adult	English	Mystery
24	BC. 1524643	The exchange : after The firm : a novel	Grisham, John,	728	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
25	BC. 1500333	Everyone here is lying	Lapena, Shari,	716	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
26	BC. 1401121	The Wager : a tale of shipwreck, mutiny, and murder	Grann, David,	686	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
27	BC. 1500429	The librarianist : a novel	deWitt, Patrick,	654	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
28	BC. 1375233	Friends, lovers, and the big terrible thing : a memoir	Perry, Matthew,	635	2023	Adult	English	Nonfiction
29	BC. 1379148	The housemaid	McFadden, Freida,	620	2023	Adult	English	Fiction
30	BC. 1500427	Learned by heart	Donoghue, Emma,	600	2023	Adult	English	Fiction

Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_2023

Figure 6: This screen capture shows the first 30 items in the cleaned 2023 Most Requested Titles dataset in Google Sheets.

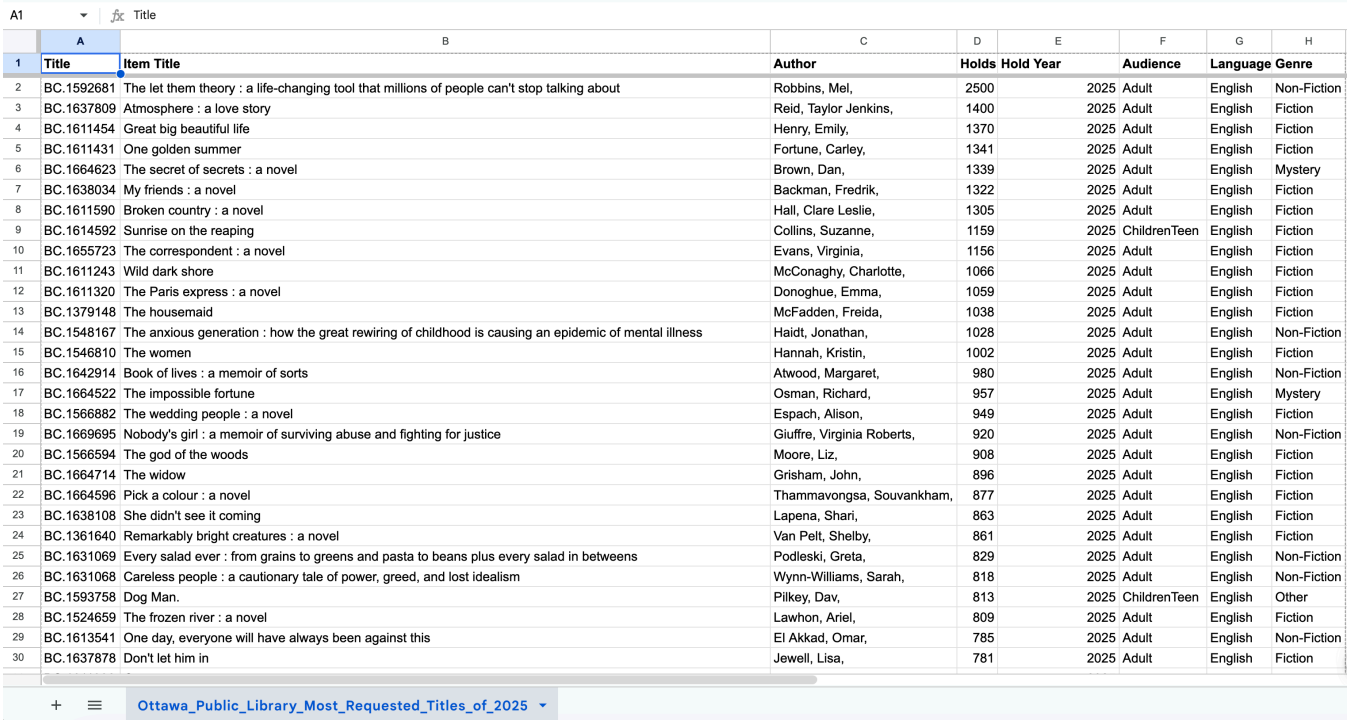


A1 | Title

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	**Title**	**Item Title**	**Author**	**Holds**	**Hold Year**	**Audience**	**Language**	**Genre**
2	BC. 1546810	The women	Hannah, Kristin,	2568	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
3	BC. 1589584	The grey wolf	Penny, Louise,	1726	2024	Adult	English	Mystery
4	BC. 1548167	The anxious generation : how the great rewiring of childhood is causing an epidemic of mental illness	Haidt, Jonathan,	1383	2024	Adult	English	Nonfiction
5	BC. 1546566	Funny story	Henry, Emily,	1259	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
6	BC. 1566505	The Briar Club : a novel	Quinn, Kate,	1244	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
7	BC. 1566850	This summer will be different	Fortune, Carley,	1083	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
8	BC. 1144833	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	Clear, James,	1054	2024	Adult	English	Nonfiction
9	BC. 1589591	Here one moment : a novel	Moriarty, Liane,	1015	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
10	BC. 1589609	Intermezzo	Rooney, Sally,	1009	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
11	BC. 1361640	Remarkably bright creatures : a novel	Van Pelt, Shelby,	1005	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
12	BC. 1566594	The god of the woods	Moore, Liz,	987	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
13	BC. 1379148	The housemaid	McFadden, Freida,	976	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
14	BC. 1546617	James : a novel	Everett, Percival,	970	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
15	BC. 1554700	Dog man.	Pilkey, Dav,	967	2024	Teen	English	Fiction
16	BC. 896089	A court of thorns and roses	Maas, Sarah J.,	943	2024	Teen	English	Fiction
17	BC. 1589716	We solve murders	Osman, Richard,	932	2024	Adult	English	Mystery
18	BC. 1592754	Revenge of the tipping point : overstories, superspreaders, and the rise of social engineering	Gladwell, Malcolm,	905	2024	Adult	English	Nonfiction
19	BC. 1401020	Outlive : the science & art of longevity	Attia, Peter,	838	2024	Adult	English	Nonfiction
20	BC. 1569302	Nexus : a brief history of information networks from the Stone Age to AI	Harari, Yuval N.,	798	2024	Adult	English	Nonfiction
21	BC. 1513422	Fourth wing	Yarros, Rebecca	776	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
22	BC. 1500302	The covenant of water : a novel	Verghese, Abraham,	759	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
23	BC. 1566466	All the colors of the dark : a novel	Whitaker, Chris,	746	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
24	BC. 1589630	The life impossible	Haig, Matt,	743	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
25	BC. 1554067	All fours	July, Miranda,	742	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
26	BC. 1546618	Just for the summer	Jimenez, Abby,	729	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
27	BC. 1566619	The housemaid is watching	McFadden, Freida,	728	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
28	BC. 1546555	First lie wins	Elston, Ashley,	718	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
29	BC. 1524697	Iron flame	Yarros, Rebecca	691	2024	Adult	English	Fiction
30	BC. 1554074	Long Island	Tóibín, Colm,	678	2024	Adult	English	Fiction

Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_2024

Figure 7: This screen capture shows the first 30 items in the cleaned 2024 Most Requested Titles dataset in Google Sheets.



A1 | Title

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	**Title**	**Item Title**	**Author**	**Holds**	**Hold Year**	**Audience**	**Language**	**Genre**
2	BC.1592681	The let them theory : a life-changing tool that millions of people can't stop talking about	Robbins, Mel,	2500	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
3	BC.1637809	Atmosphere : a love story	Reid, Taylor Jenkins,	1400	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
4	BC.1611454	Great big beautiful life	Henry, Emily,	1370	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
5	BC.1611431	One golden summer	Fortune, Carley,	1341	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
6	BC.1664623	The secret of secrets : a novel	Brown, Dan,	1339	2025	Adult	English	Mystery
7	BC.1638034	My friends : a novel	Backman, Fredrik,	1322	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
8	BC.1611590	Broken country : a novel	Hall, Clare Leslie,	1305	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
9	BC.1614592	Sunrise on the reaping	Collins, Suzanne,	1159	2025	ChildrenTeen	English	Fiction
10	BC.1655723	The correspondent : a novel	Evans, Virginia,	1156	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
11	BC.1611243	Wild dark shore	McConaghy, Charlotte,	1066	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
12	BC.1611320	The Paris express : a novel	Donoghue, Emma,	1059	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
13	BC.1379148	The housemaid	McFadden, Freida,	1038	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
14	BC.1548167	The anxious generation : how the great rewiring of childhood is causing an epidemic of mental illness	Haidt, Jonathan,	1028	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
15	BC.1546810	The women	Hannah, Kristin,	1002	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
16	BC.1642914	Book of lives : a memoir of sorts	Atwood, Margaret,	980	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
17	BC.1664522	The impossible fortune	Osman, Richard,	957	2025	Adult	English	Mystery
18	BC.1566882	The wedding people : a novel	Espach, Alison,	949	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
19	BC.1669695	Nobody's girl : a memoir of surviving abuse and fighting for justice	Giuffre, Virginia Roberts,	920	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
20	BC.1566594	The god of the woods	Moore, Liz,	908	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
21	BC.1664714	The widow	Grisham, John,	896	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
22	BC.1664596	Pick a colour : a novel	Thammavongsa, Souvankham,	877	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
23	BC.1638108	She didn't see it coming	Lapena, Shari,	863	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
24	BC.1361640	Remarkably bright creatures : a novel	Van Pelt, Shelby,	861	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
25	BC.1631069	Every salad ever : from grains to greens and pasta to beans plus every salad in betweens	Podleski, Greta,	829	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
26	BC.1631068	Careless people : a cautionary tale of power, greed, and lost idealism	Wynn-Williams, Sarah,	818	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
27	BC.1593758	Dog Man.	Pilkey, Dav,	813	2025	ChildrenTeen	English	Other
28	BC.1524659	The frozen river : a novel	Lawhon, Ariel,	809	2025	Adult	English	Fiction
29	BC.1613541	One day, everyone will have always been against this	El Akkad, Omar,	785	2025	Adult	English	Non-Fiction
30	BC.1637878	Don't let him in	Jewell, Lisa,	781	2025	Adult	English	Fiction

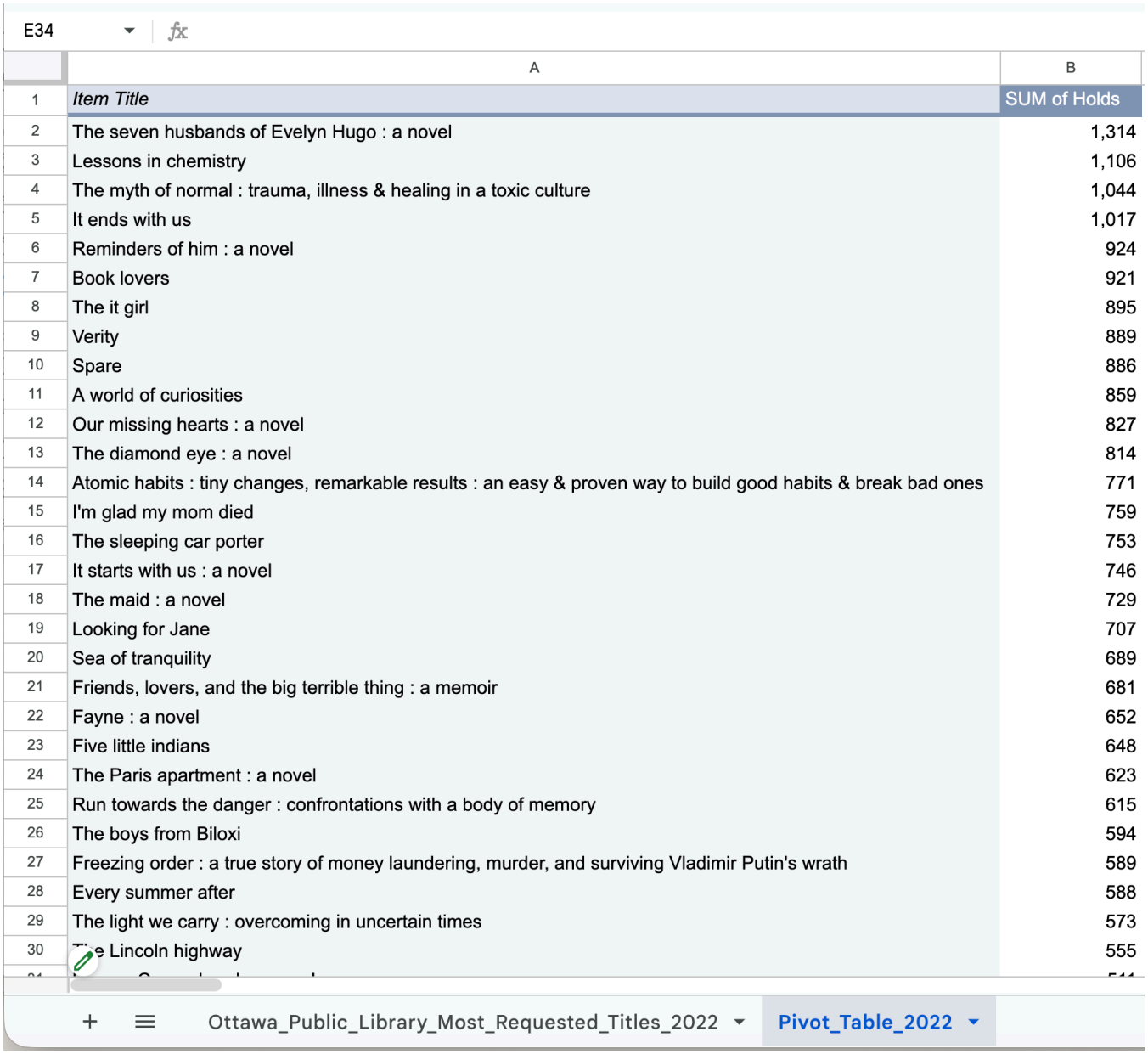
Ottawa_Public_Library_Most_Requested_Titles_of_2025

Figure 8: This screen capture shows the first 30 items in the cleaned 2025 Most Requested Titles dataset in Google Sheets.

I used `=SPLIT(A1, "by", FALSE)` on the 2022 and 2023 BookTok reading list imports to separate the title and author names into two different columns for clarity and consistency with the other lists.

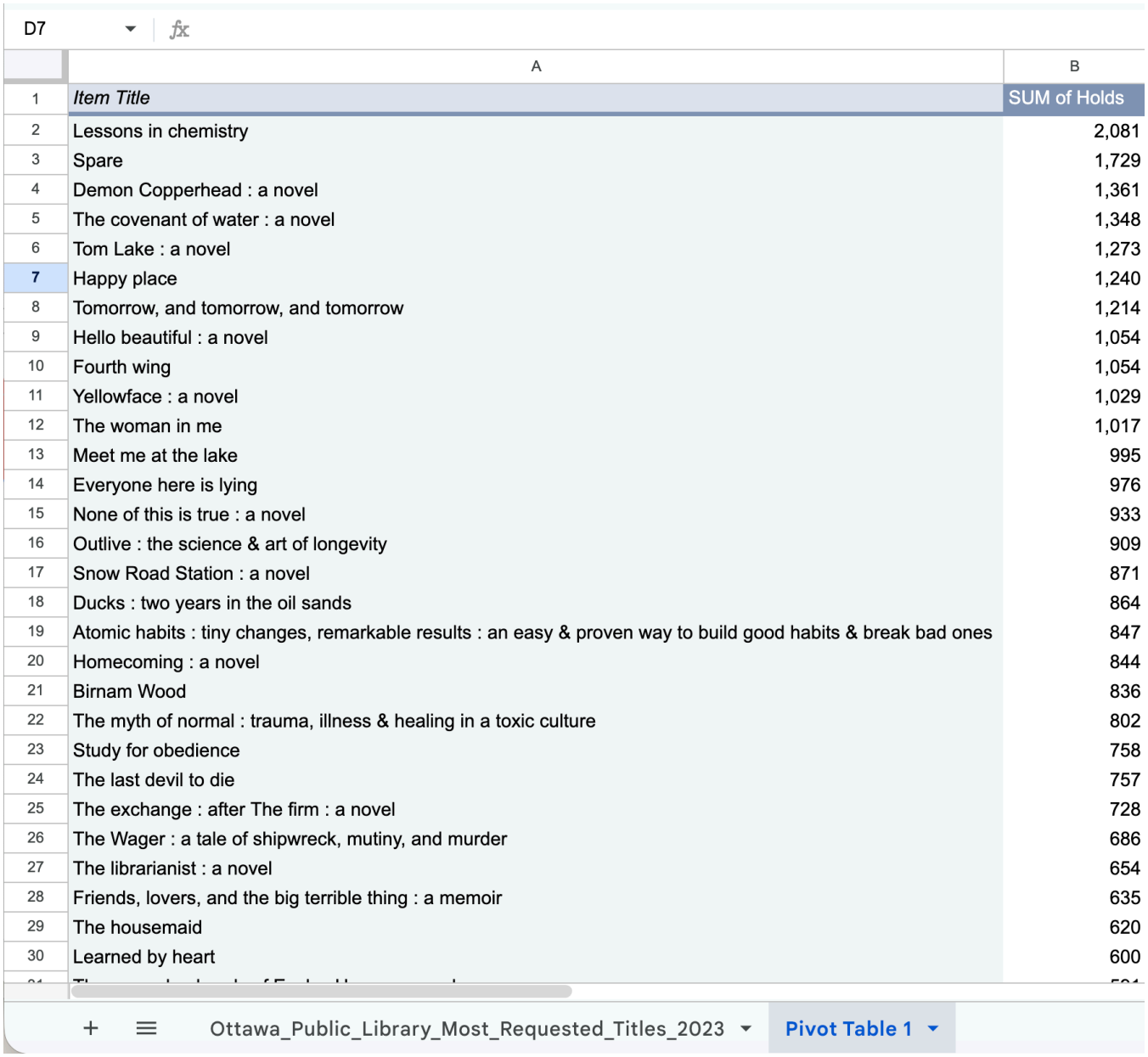
2.3. Analyzing Data

For my pivot tables, I added Item Titles in rows, and Holds for the value. I sorted the rows in descending order by the sum of holds. I chose to use these values because, for my intended story,the item titles and number of times they were requested will be the most relevant for comparison.



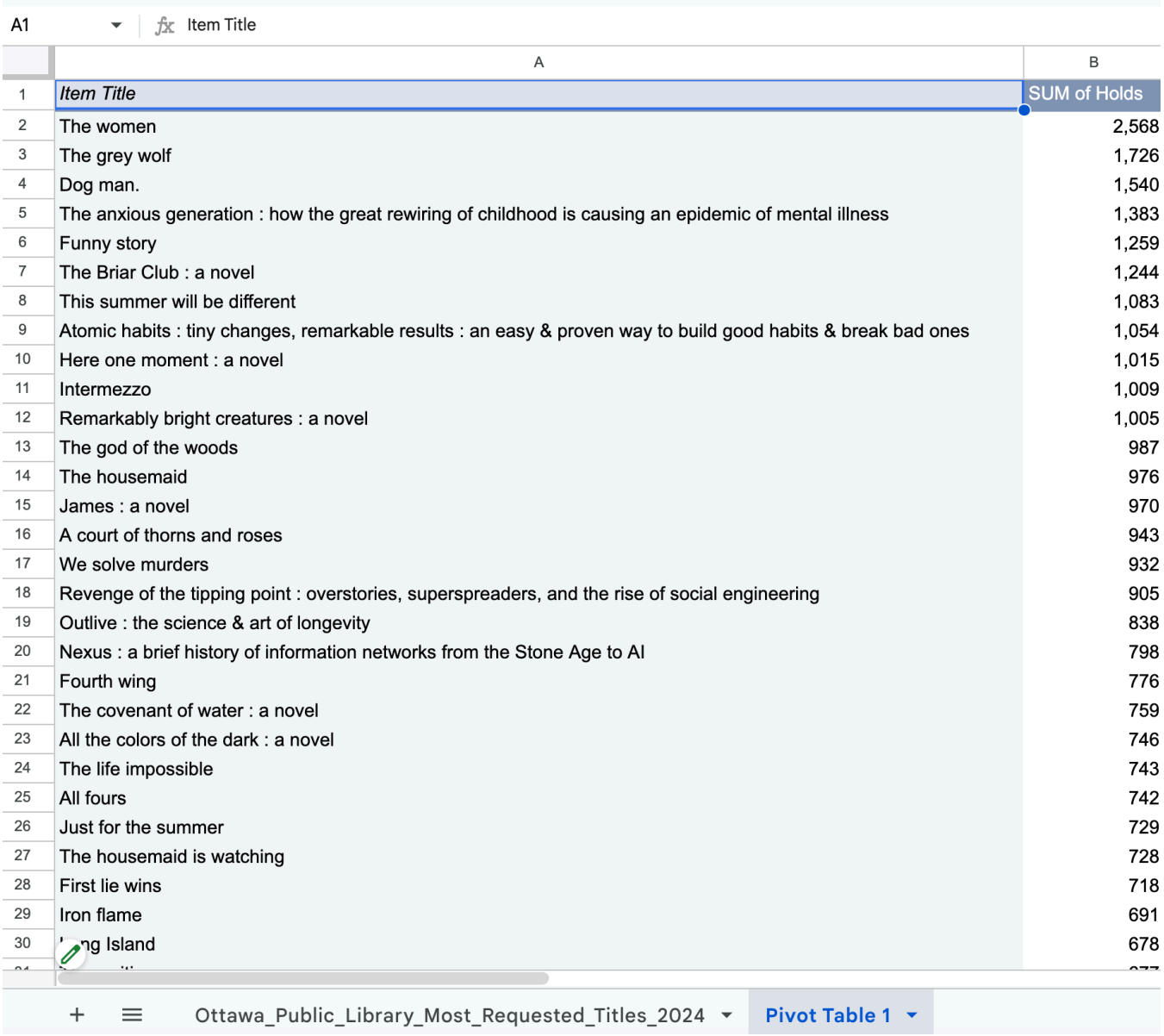
	A	B
1	*Item Title*	SUM of Holds
2	The seven husbands of Evelyn Hugo : a novel	1,314
3	Lessons in chemistry	1,106
4	The myth of normal : trauma, illness & healing in a toxic culture	1,044
5	It ends with us	1,017
6	Reminders of him : a novel	924
7	Book lovers	921
8	The it girl	895
9	Verity	889
10	Spare	886
11	A world of curiosities	859
12	Our missing hearts : a novel	827
13	The diamond eye : a novel	814
14	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	771
15	I'm glad my mom died	759
16	The sleeping car porter	753
17	It starts with us : a novel	746
18	The maid : a novel	729
19	Looking for Jane	707
20	Sea of tranquility	689
21	Friends, lovers, and the big terrible thing : a memoir	681
22	Fayne : a novel	652
23	Five little indians	648
24	The Paris apartment : a novel	623
25	Run towards the danger : confrontations with a body of memory	615
26	The boys from Biloxi	594
27	Freezing order : a true story of money laundering, murder, and surviving Vladimir Putin's wrath	589
28	Every summer after	588
29	The light we carry : overcoming in uncertain times	573
30	The Lincoln highway	555

Figure 9: This pivot table shows the first 30 items of the 2022 most requested titles list sorted in descending order by sum of holds.



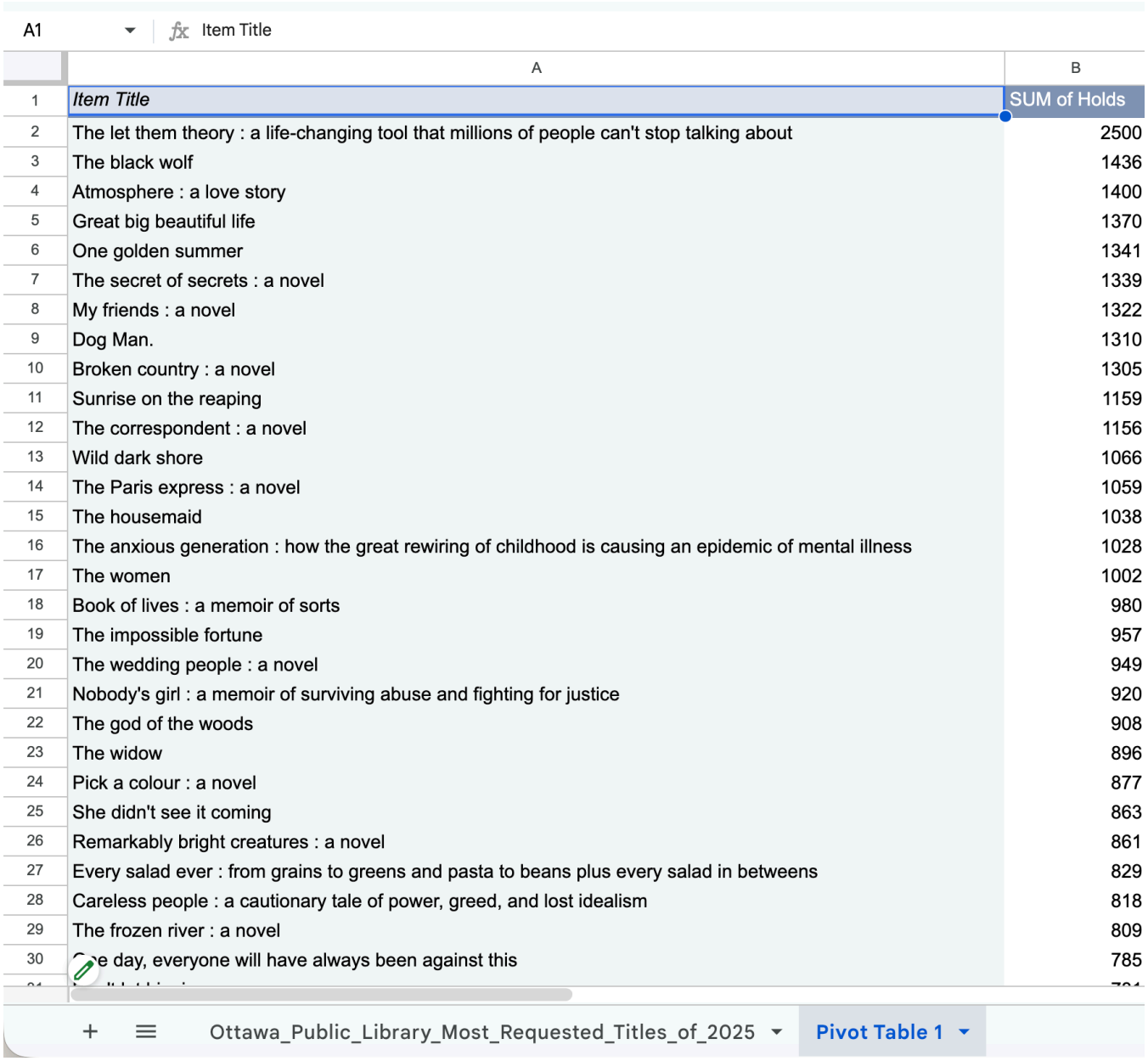
	A	B
1	*Item Title*	SUM of Holds
2	Lessons in chemistry	2,081
3	Spare	1,729
4	Demon Copperhead : a novel	1,361
5	The covenant of water : a novel	1,348
6	Tom Lake : a novel	1,273
7	Happy place	1,240
8	Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow	1,214
9	Hello beautiful : a novel	1,054
10	Fourth wing	1,054
11	Yellowface : a novel	1,029
12	The woman in me	1,017
13	Meet me at the lake	995
14	Everyone here is lying	976
15	None of this is true : a novel	933
16	Outlive : the science & art of longevity	909
17	Snow Road Station : a novel	871
18	Ducks : two years in the oil sands	864
19	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	847
20	Homecoming : a novel	844
21	Birnam Wood	836
22	The myth of normal : trauma, illness & healing in a toxic culture	802
23	Study for obedience	758
24	The last devil to die	757
25	The exchange : after The firm : a novel	728
26	The Wager : a tale of shipwreck, mutiny, and murder	686
27	The librarianist : a novel	654
28	Friends, lovers, and the big terrible thing : a memoir	635
29	The housemaid	620
30	Learned by heart	600

Figure 10: This pivot table shows the first 30 items of the 2023 most requested titles list sorted in descending order by sum of holds.



	A	B
1	*Item Title*	SUM of Holds
2	The women	2,568
3	The grey wolf	1,726
4	Dog man.	1,540
5	The anxious generation : how the great rewiring of childhood is causing an epidemic of mental illness	1,383
6	Funny story	1,259
7	The Briar Club : a novel	1,244
8	This summer will be different	1,083
9	Atomic habits : tiny changes, remarkable results : an easy & proven way to build good habits & break bad ones	1,054
10	Here one moment : a novel	1,015
11	Intermezzo	1,009
12	Remarkably bright creatures : a novel	1,005
13	The god of the woods	987
14	The housemaid	976
15	James : a novel	970
16	A court of thorns and roses	943
17	We solve murders	932
18	Revenge of the tipping point : overstories, superspreaders, and the rise of social engineering	905
19	Outlive : the science & art of longevity	838
20	Nexus : a brief history of information networks from the Stone Age to AI	798
21	Fourth wing	776
22	The covenant of water : a novel	759
23	All the colors of the dark : a novel	746
24	The life impossible	743
25	All fours	742
26	Just for the summer	729
27	The housemaid is watching	728
28	First lie wins	718
29	Iron flame	691
30	ng Island	678

Figure 11: This pivot table shows the first 30 items of the 2024 most requested titles list sorted in descending order by sum of holds.



	A	B
1	*Item Title*	SUM of Holds
2	The let them theory : a life-changing tool that millions of people can't stop talking about	2500
3	The black wolf	1436
4	Atmosphere : a love story	1400
5	Great big beautiful life	1370
6	One golden summer	1341
7	The secret of secrets : a novel	1339
8	My friends : a novel	1322
9	Dog Man.	1310
10	Broken country : a novel	1305
11	Sunrise on the reaping	1159
12	The correspondent : a novel	1156
13	Wild dark shore	1066
14	The Paris express : a novel	1059
15	The housemaid	1038
16	The anxious generation : how the great rewiring of childhood is causing an epidemic of mental illness	1028
17	The women	1002
18	Book of lives : a memoir of sorts	980
19	The impossible fortune	957
20	The wedding people : a novel	949
21	Nobody's girl : a memoir of surviving abuse and fighting for justice	920
22	The god of the woods	908
23	The widow	896
24	Pick a colour : a novel	877
25	She didn't see it coming	863
26	Remarkably bright creatures : a novel	861
27	Every salad ever : from grains to greens and pasta to beans plus every salad in betweens	829
28	Careless people : a cautionary tale of power, greed, and lost idealism	818
29	The frozen river : a novel	809
30	One day, everyone will have always been against this	785

Figure 12: This pivot table shows the first 30 items of the 2025 most requested titles list sorted in descending order by sum of holds.

For my exploratory charts, I decided to sort it by prevalence of genre. If I choose to write my story about how the OPL has experienced a similar demand for certain genres as local bookstores, this visualization will aid significantly.

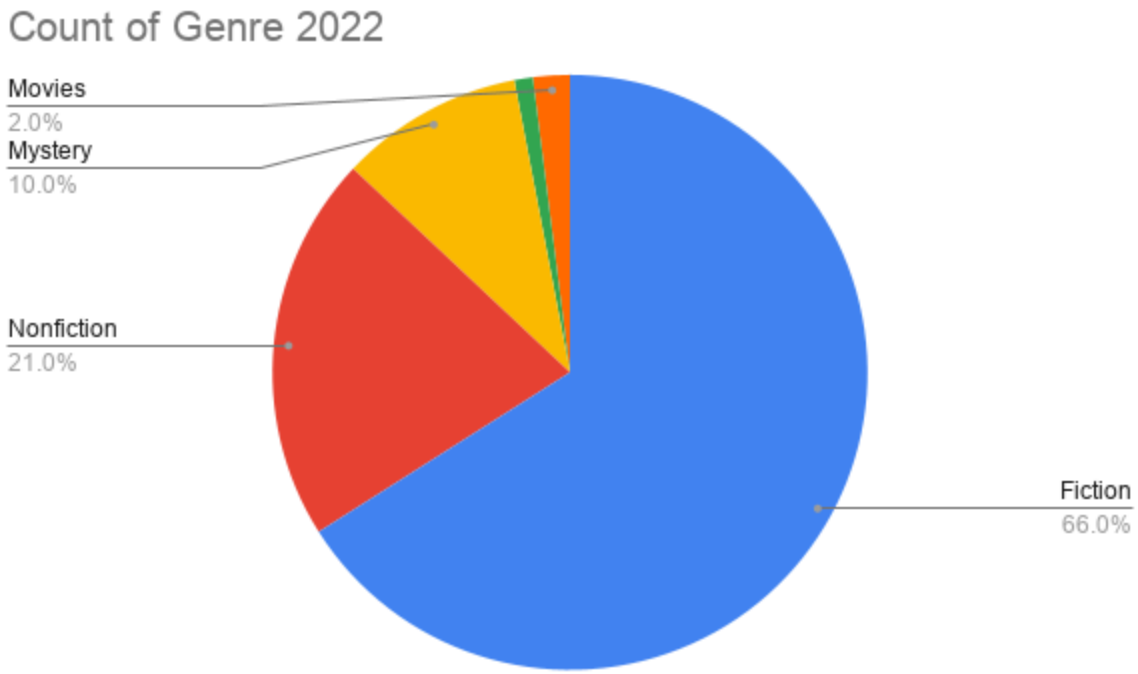


Figure 13: This exploratory chart shows the most common genres in the 2022 list of most requested titles.

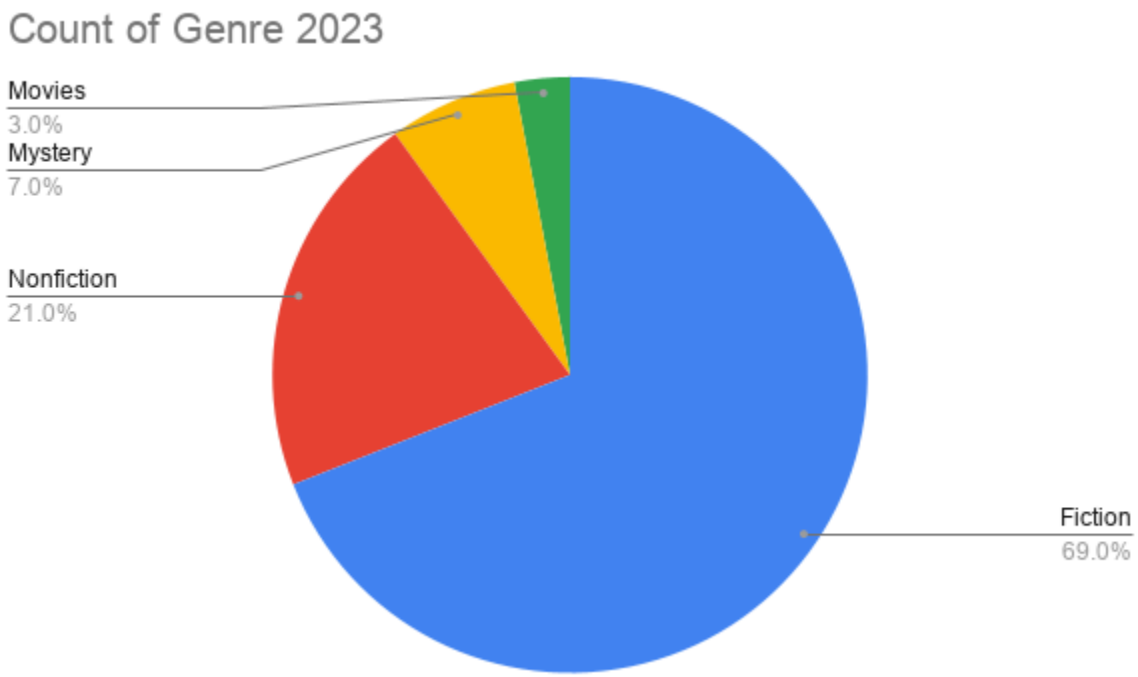


Figure 14: This exploratory chart shows the most common genres in the 2023 list of most requested titles.

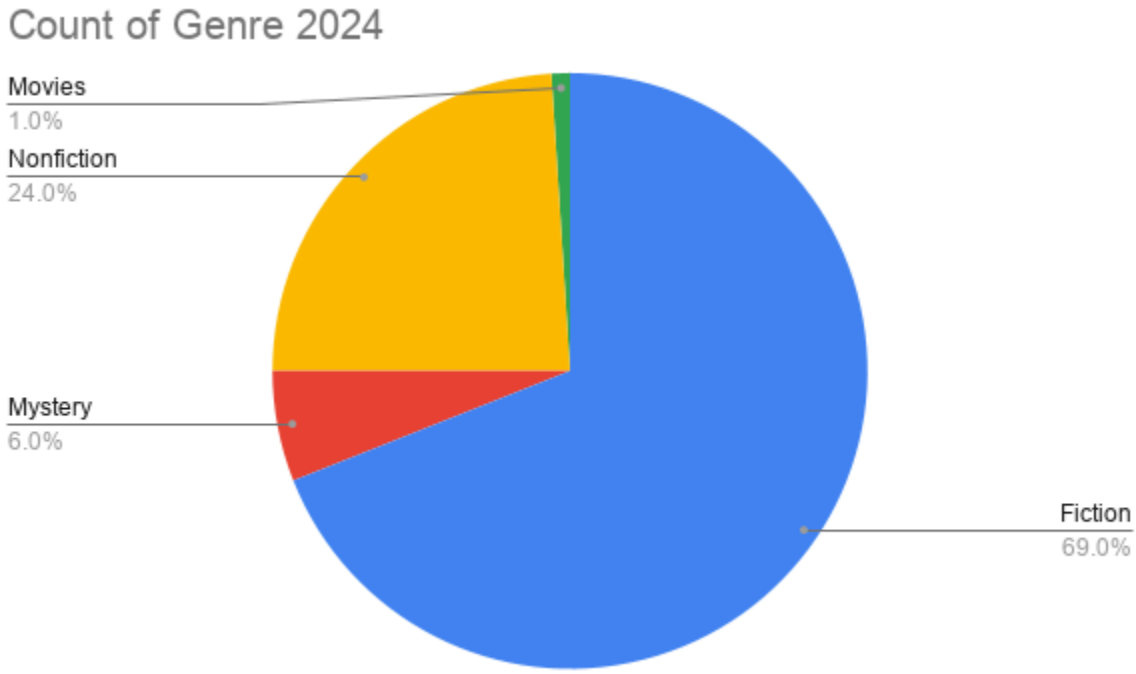


Figure 15: This exploratory chart shows the most common genres in the 2024 list of most requested titles.

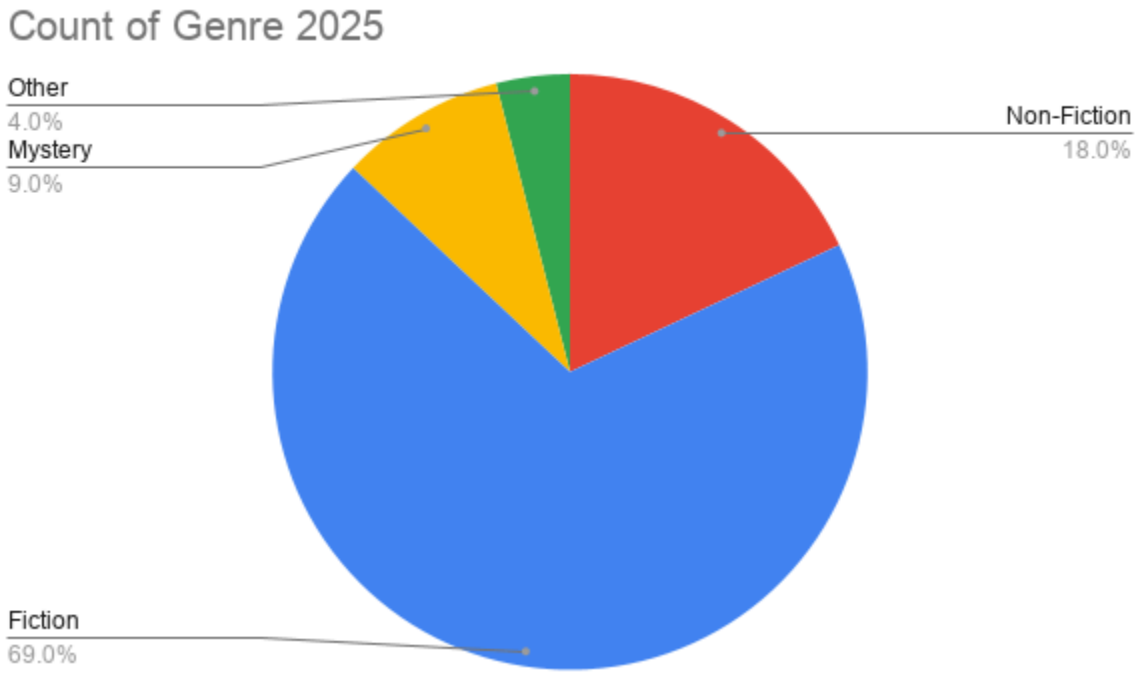


Figure 16: This exploratory chart shows the most common genres in the 2025 list of most requested titles.

3. Delivering Data

As mentioned, I think I have two logical paths I could take using these datasets.

1. By comparing titles from BookTok reading lists to titles in the OPL most requested lists, I could explore the evident influence social media has had on the novels Ottawa readers are borrowing. It could shine a positive light on BookTok and how it contributed to the increase of readers during the pandemic.
2. By comparing the most prevelant genres within the OPL most requested list with what local bookstores reportedly saw an increased demand in, I could explore how the popularization of certain genres has led to an increase in customers and borrowers at both the OPL and local bookstores. For example, Capital Current published a piece with testimony that some bookstores had "essentially doubled the amount of fiction books" in store (Guido & Hartmann, 2025), and the pie charts for all four years (2022-2025) have fiction as the most requested genre.

To tell either of these stories, I feel I would need to find more consistent "reading lists" for the most popular BookTok titles from 2022-2025. Currently, my lists are different lengths and I would ideally like a top 10 or top 20 for each year, but that might require I redownload TikTok and do my own investigating for some community compilation.

Booktokbooks.com seems like it could be a valuable source for either of these stories. As an independent discovery catalog, they create unsponsored and non-affiliated reading guides by searching for themes associated with BookTok. Unfortunately, they do not have any reading lists for past years.

4. References

Rohrer, Julia. (2023). *Non-representative samples! What could possibly go wrong?*. The 100% CI. [https://www.the100.ci/2023/03/07/non-representative-samples-what-could-possibly-go-wrong/]

Guido, C. & Hartmann, C. (2025). *BookTok turns a page in Ottawa's literary scene*. Capital Current. [https://capitalcurrent.ca/booktok-ottawa/]

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